

MARKETING RESEARCH PROJECT

# Reaching Every Shelf:

## Danone Egypt's Distribution and Availability Challenge

*Applying Malhotra's Marketing Research Process (Chapters 1 to 5)*

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EMBA Program | 2026 • Course project: full research cycle, consumer survey N = 35

# A Full-Cycle Learning Exercise

This is a course project. Our objective was to correctly walk the ENTIRE marketing research process, from problem definition to final recommendation, applying every chapter in sequence, not to publish market-grade data.

### What we set out to do

- Define, design, collect, analyze, and report, every stage in order
- Use both qualitative (interviews) and quantitative (survey) methods
- State four hypotheses and test them against the data we gathered
- Reach a defensible management recommendation at the end

### What we are transparent about

- Convenience sample, N = 35, urban-skewed: indicative, not representative
- The five retailer interviews are simulated composites built from secondary sources, used to illustrate the qualitative method, not offered as field evidence
- The value here is the process, executed correctly from start to end

# What This Project Covers

1

## The Problem

Danone's reach gap vs Juhayna

2

## Problem Definition

Decision problem, research problem, hypotheses

3

## Research Design

Exploratory + descriptive, secondary data

4

## Qualitative Research

Depth interviews with shop owners

5

## The Survey & Results

Live consumer survey, N = 35, findings

6

## Recommendations

Answering the management question

## THE PROBLEM

# Danone Reaches Far Fewer Shops Than Juhayna

In Egypt's dairy market the battle is won at the small grocery store. Juhayna's vast owned fleet puts it on far more shelves than Danone.

~243,000

outlets reached by Juhayna

~100,000

points of sale reached by Danone

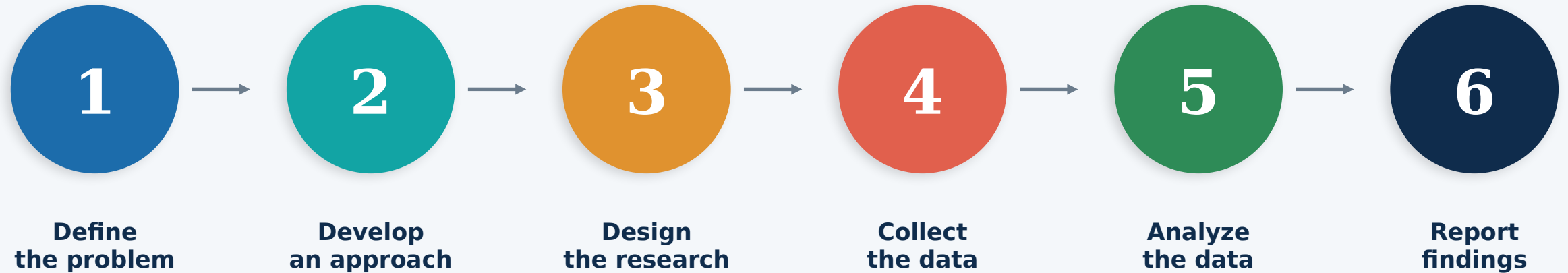
~40-60%

coverage gap vs Juhayna

### Why it matters

Small traditional grocers are 96.6% of all outlets and about 74% of dairy sales. When Danone is not on the shelf, shoppers simply buy whatever brand is there.

# The Marketing Research Process We Followed



**How this maps to our report:** Steps 1-2 are Chapter 2, Step 3 is Chapter 3, Step 4 is Chapters 4 and 5 (interviews + survey), Steps 5-6 are the analysis and this report.

# The Company and the Market

## Danone Egypt

- Competes in dairy: yogurt, Activia, and Danette desserts
- Strategy built on premium, branded, value-added products
- Activia grew in 2024 on a gut-health and immunity message
- Competes through brand strength, not mass reach

## The Egyptian Dairy Market

- Worth about USD 2.37 billion in 2024 and growing fast
- Crowded: Juhayna, Domty, Almarai/Beyti, Lactalis, Danone
- Local champions are vertically integrated and low cost
- Traditional small shops dominate distribution and sales

# Defining the Problem

## Management Decision Problem

*What should management DO?*

“Should Danone Egypt expand its distribution reach to compete with Juhayna's coverage in the Egyptian dairy market?”

## Marketing Research Problem

*What INFORMATION do we need?*

Determine how limited availability affects consumers' yogurt choices and Danone's lost sales, and identify the distribution barriers from the retailer's side.

# Research Questions and Hypotheses

We test four hypotheses with the survey data:

H  
1

Availability significantly influences which yogurt brand consumers choose.

H  
2

Danone's perceived availability is significantly lower than Juhayna's.

H  
3

Many consumers have switched away from Danone because it was not available.

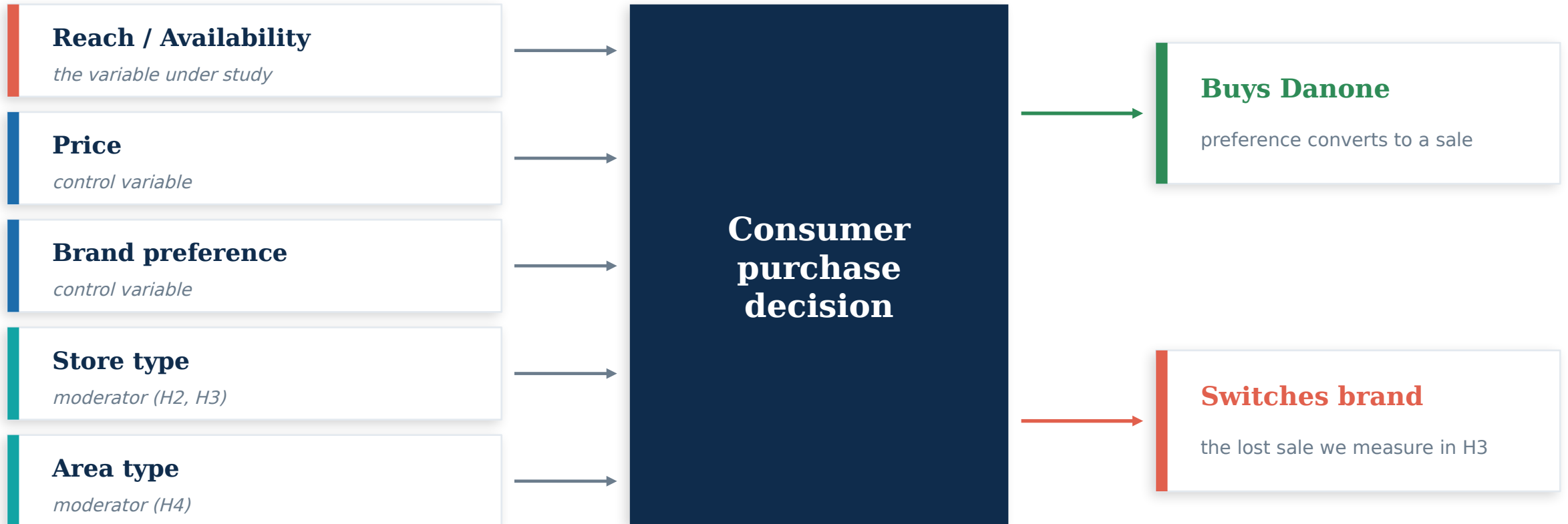
H  
4

The availability gap is wider in rural areas than in major cities.



# The Conceptual Model Behind the Hypotheses

Five variables feed one consumer outcome. Each hypothesis tests one arrow of this model.



**The model in one line:** *Reach/Availability + Price + Brand preference + Store type + Area type → Purchase vs Brand-switch*

# Research Design: Two of the Three Types, by Choice

## USED

### Exploratory

*Understand the issue*

- Secondary data on the market and distribution networks
- Depth interviews with small-shop owners
- Sharpens the survey questions

## USED

### Descriptive

*Quantify the relationships (cross-sectional)*

- A single structured consumer survey
- Measures availability, choice, switching
- Tests the four hypotheses

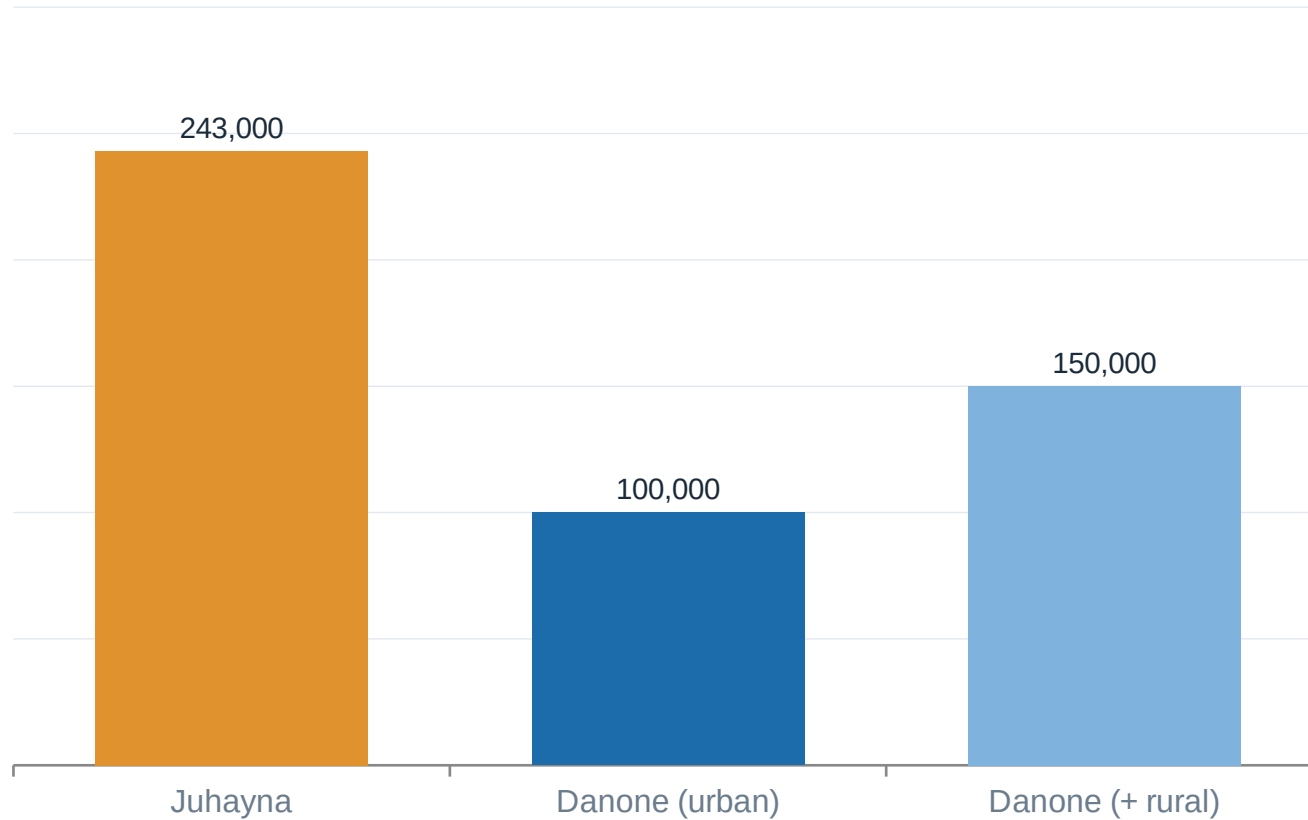
## NOT USED

### Causal

*Prove that X causes Y (experiment)*

- Would need a field experiment: vary availability, watch sales
- Not feasible in a course timeline or without Danone's cooperation
- So our verdicts are associations, stated as such, not proven causation

# Secondary Data: The Distribution Gap



## By the numbers

- Juhayna: 39 distribution centers, 1,000+ vehicles
- Danone: 31 centers (7 direct, 24 indirect)
- Danone rural reach via ~380 micro-distributors
- Juhayna's network is hard and costly to replicate

# The Small Shop Decides the Game

**96.6%**

of all retail outlets in Egypt

**74%**

of total dairy sales

**113,724**

traditional grocers  
nationwide

**\$2.37B**

dairy market size, 2024

*When the decisive channel is the neighbourhood shop, shelf presence is everything.*

# Why Juhayna Wins the Shelf

*Five retailer depth interviews, from city centre to village (illustrative composites). Five themes recur.*

### Rep / van visits

Juhayna calls weekly to twice-weekly, to the door. Danone ranges from once a week in a big Cairo shop to never in the village.

### Delivery

Juhayna delivers and stacks. Danone usually must be collected from a wholesaler, which lone and rural shops cannot do.

### Risk terms

Juhayna: small minimums, light credit, takes back near-expiry stock. Danone: cash up front, larger minimum, spoilage is the grocer's loss.

### The cooler

Juhayna and Almarai supply the branded fridge. Danone rarely does; in the village, cooler plus cold delivery is the whole game.

### Demand pull

Customers ask by name for Activia and Danette and will wait. For plain yogurt they take whatever is on the shelf.

*The gap widens monotonically: present on city main streets → "Danone stops at the big city" → simply absent in the village.*

# The Survey: Our Primary Data

## Live electronic survey (Google Forms)

- Self-administered, in Egyptian Arabic, about 4 minutes
- Distributed via WhatsApp and social media
- Convenience and snowball sampling; target was 100 to 150
- Achieved N = 35 valid responses (pilot scale, indicative)
- Online and urban skew noted; offset by the retailer interviews

## Each question earns its place

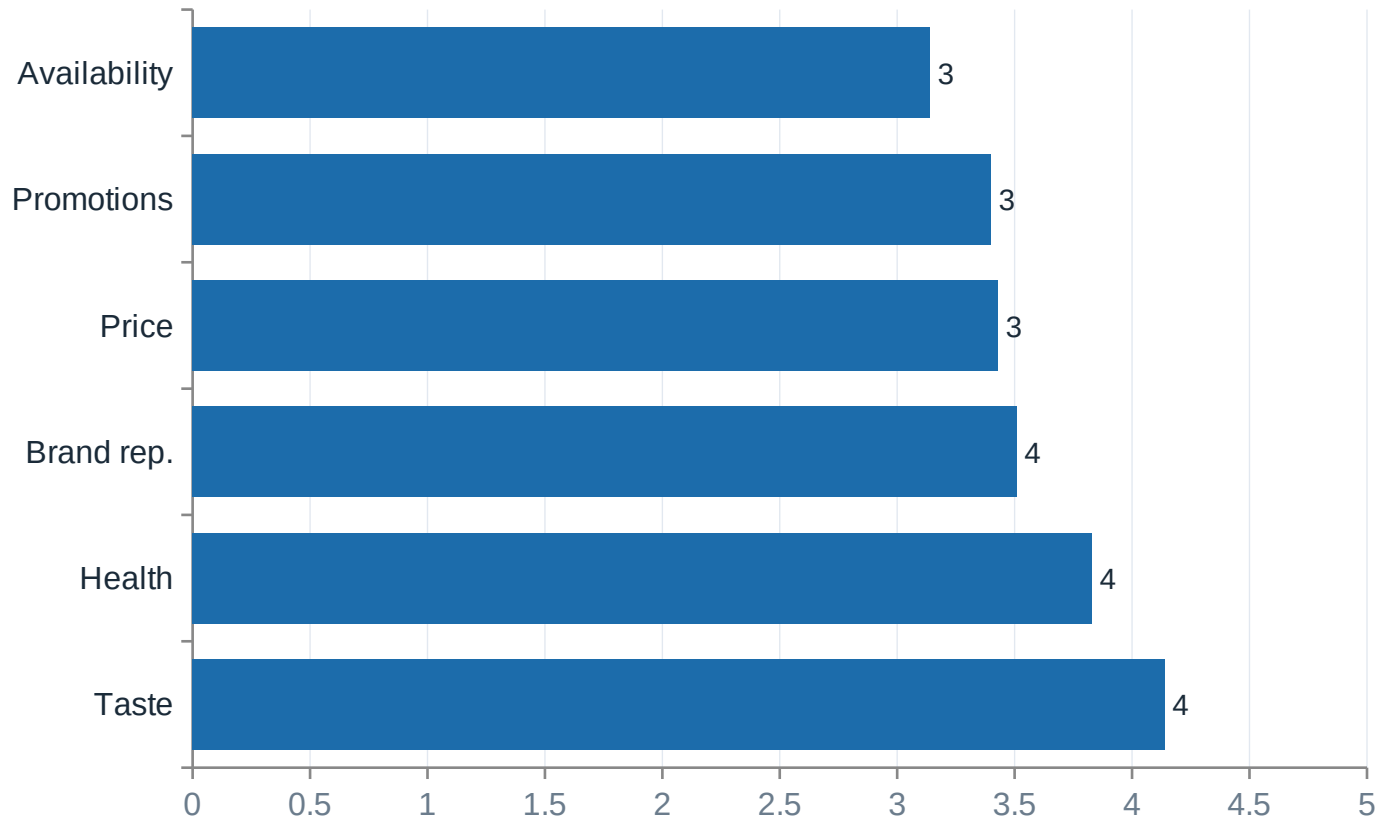
H1 - importance of availability

H2 - availability grid: Danone vs Juhayna

H3 - preferred vs actually-bought gap

H4 - availability split by area type

# Who Answered, and What Drives Choice



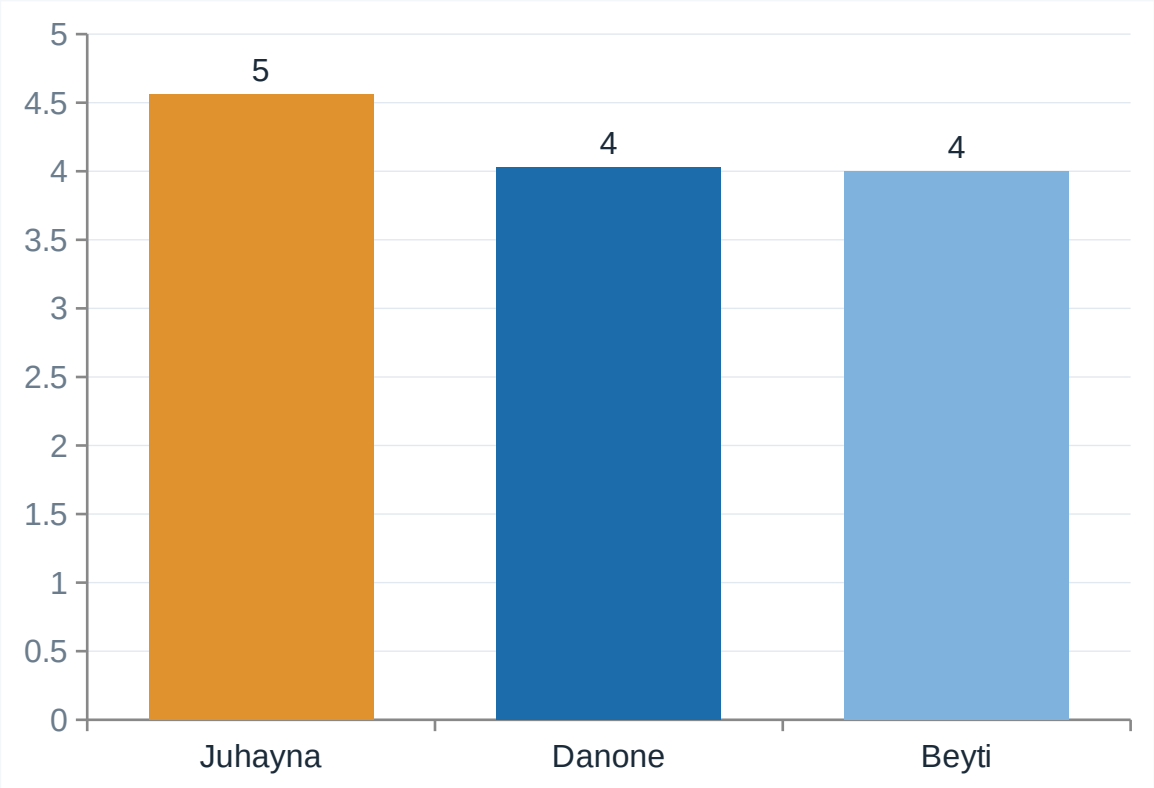
## The sample (N = 35)

- Alexandria 24, Sharqia 6, Cairo 2, Dakahlia 2, Beheira 1
- Major city 23, town 10, village 2
- Only 7 (20%) buy from a small grocery, the key channel
- Skews urban and modern-trade, so it understates the gap

***H1: availability ranks LAST of six drivers (3.14). It is a silent gatekeeper, not a stated preference.***

# The Gap Is Real, and It Costs Sales

## H2 — Perceived availability (mean, 1-5)



Gap = 0.53. Modest at the consumer level, but the urban sample understates it.

## H3 — Unrealised demand and switching

**11 vs 5**

prefer Danone vs actually buy it most → a gap of 6

**32 of 35**

bought a competing brand when Danone was missing

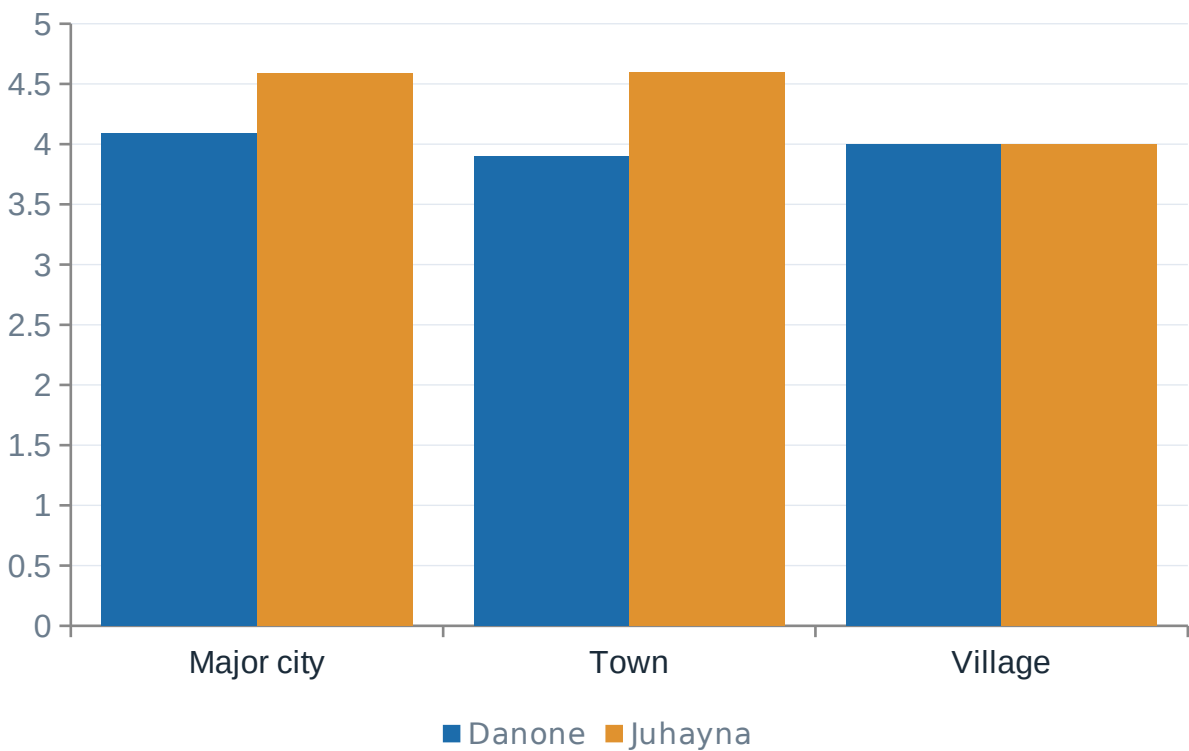
**Premium line**

lost sales concentrate in Activia and Danette, where buyers ask by name and will wait



# By Area, and the Verdict on Each Hypothesis

## H4 — Danone vs Juhayna availability by area



City-to-town dip in the survey; only 2 rural respondents, so H4 leans on the interviews.

- H1** Not supported as a stated driver  
ranks 6th of 6 (3.14)
- H2** Supported (modestly)  
4.03 vs 4.56, gap 0.53
- H3** Supported  
prefer 11 / buy 5; 32 of 35 switched
- H4** Directionally supported  
city-town dip; clear in interviews

# Recommendations

The binding constraint is route-to-market, not the product. Four moves, in priority order:

## Fix the route-to-market

Match Juhayna's three shelf-winning levers: scheduled rep visits, near-expiry returns or consignment, and smaller minimum orders. Not advertising.

## Lead with the premium line

Push Activia and Danette first, where brand-locked demand and the best retailer margin make an availability fix pay back fastest.

## Towns before villages

Densify suburban and town coverage first for quick payback, then reach the rural last mile via micro-distributors and solar coolers.

## Provide the cooler

Supply the branded fridge: a merchandising asset and the precondition for stocking chilled product where power is unreliable.

# Limitations and What the Exercise Taught Us

We would rather name the limits of a course-scale study than overclaim. This is where a real project would go next.

## Honest limitations

- Sample: convenience, N = 35, Alexandria and urban-skewed; only 7 buy from small grocers, the key channel, so the gap is understated
- Interviews: five simulated composites from secondary sources, not real fieldwork
- Results are directional and indicative, not statistically representative

## With more time, and what we learned

- Scale to 100 to 150 respondents with genuine rural and small-grocer representation
- Run real depth interviews with shop owners in each area type
- The core learning: designing and executing the full research cycle correctly, from problem definition through to a defensible recommendation

# Everything Is Online: Scan or Click

## The full project site (Arabic)

Interactive report: problem, method, live results, and all the files, readable on any phone.



<https://amsamms.github.io/danone-distribution-research/>

## The live consumer survey

The actual Google Form (Arabic) our 35 respondents filled. Still live: try it yourself.



[docs.google.com/forms/...](https://docs.google.com/forms/...) (scan the code)

# Thank You

Questions and discussion

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# The Retailer Depth-Interview Guide

Retailer Interview Guide | Danone Egypt Distribution

Retailer Depth-Interview Guide

Qualitative Research (Malhotra Chapter 4) - Danone Egypt Distribution Project

Interviewer: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_ Shop area: ( ) City centre ( ) Town / suburb ( ) Village / rural

Method

Semi-structured, one-to-one depth interview, about 10 to 15 minutes. Talk to the owner of a small grocery store. Take notes (or record with permission). Aim for 3 to 5 retailers, mixing at least one city shop and one village shop. Goal: understand the supply side, that is, why small shops stock Juhayna more readily than Danone.

Before you start

Introduce yourself and the academic purpose, promise confidentiality, and ask permission to take notes.

Shop profile (warm-up)

1. How long have you run this shop? Roughly how many customers a day?

2. Roughly what share of your sales is dairy and yogurt?

Brands stocked

3. Which yogurt and dairy brands do you currently stock? (let them list freely)

4. Which one sells the most? Why do you think that is?

The core: Danone vs Juhayna

5. Do you stock Danone? Why or why not?

6. How often does the Juhayna sales rep / van visit you? And the Danone one?

7. Who delivers to your door, and who do you have to order or collect from yourself?

Retailer Interview Guide | Danone Egypt Distribution

8. Differences in minimum order size, payment terms (cash vs credit), returns of expired stock, and fridge or cooler provided by the company?

9. Which company is easier to deal with, and why?

Demand vs availability

10. Do customers ever ask for Danone when you don't have it? What do they do then?

11. If Danone were as easy to get and as well-supported as Juhayna, would you stock more of it?

Wrap-up

12. In one sentence: what is the main reason Juhayna is on more shelves than Danone?

13. Anything else about dealing with dairy companies you would want them to know?

Arabic field cheat-sheet

Useful phrasings to ask the questions naturally:

(?which yogurt brands do you stock) بتجيب أنواع زيادي إيه؟

(?how often does the Juhayna rep visit? and Danone) مندوب جهينة بيعدي عليك كل قد إيه؟ ودانون؟

do customers ask for Danone when it is not available? what do they do) العميل بيطلب دانون ومش بتلاقية؟ بيعمل إيه ساعتها؟

(?main reason Juhayna is in more shops than Danone) إيه أكثر سبب إن جهينة موجودة في محلات أكثر من دانون؟

How these findings feed the report

Code the answers into themes: rep / van visit frequency, delivery and terms, fridge support, customer demand pull, and margins. Quote two or three exact lines per theme. Use them in Chapter 4 to explain why the availability gap measured in the survey exists.

Danone Egypt Distribution | Marketing Research

22

# The Consumer Survey As Respondents Saw It

استبيان دانون مصر – التوافر والتوزيع

ده استبيان قصير لمشروع أكاديمي (ماجستير إدارة الأعمال) عن طريقة شراء المصريين للزبادي ومنتجات الألبان. يحدد حوالي ٤ دقائق ومجهول تمامًا. مفيش إجابة صح أو غلط. شكرًا لوقتكم.

القسم أ – أسئلة تمهيدية والاستهلاك

س١. هل تشتري ألب أو أسبرك زبادي / منتجات ألبان؟ \*

نعم ☐

لا ☐

س٢. كل قد إيه أسبرك تشتري زبادي؟ \*

يوميًا ☐

كدا مرة في الأسبوع ☐

مرة في الأسبوع ☐

كدا مرة في الشهر ☐

نادرًا ☐

س٣. مين عادة اللي يشتري الزبادي في البيت؟ \*

أنا ☐

الزوج/الزوجة ☐

أحد الوالدين ☐

فرد آخر من الأسرة ☐

القسم ب – أماكن الشراء والمنتجات

س٤. يشتري الزبادي عادة مين؟ (اختر كل ما ينطبق) \*

بقالة صغيرة ☐

سوبر ماركت ☐

هايبير ماركت ☐

بائع متجول / محل ألبان ☐

أولايين / تطبيق توصيل ☐

أخرى:

س٥. أيها ماركات زبادي اشتريتها خلال آخر ٣ شهور؟ (اختر كل ما ينطبق) \*

جهينة ☐

دانون ☐

المراعي/بينى ☐

لمار ☐

دومنى ☐

ألبان محلية / غير معروفة ☐

أخرى:

أخرى:

س٦. أيها ماركه واحده بتشتريها أكثر؟ \*

جهينة ☐

دانون ☐

المراعي/بينى ☐

لمار ☐

دومنى ☐

محلية ☐

أخرى:

س٧. أيها ماركه واحده بتقلها أكثر (بعض النظر عن اللي بتشتريه فعلاً)؟ \*

جهينة ☐

دانون ☐

المراعي/بينى ☐

لمار ☐

دومنى ☐

محلية ☐

أخرى:

القسم ج – محددات الاختيار

س٨. لما بتختار ماركه زبادي، قد إيه كل عامل مهم؟ \*

| ١ - غير مهم           | ٢                     | ٣                     | ٤                     | ٥ - مهم جدًا          |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
| <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
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| <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |

القسم د – التوافر

س٩. في المحل اللي بتشتري منه عادة، كل ماركه بتكون متوفرة قد إيه؟ \*

| دائمًا                | غالبًا                | أحيانًا               | نادرًا                | أبدًا                 | لا أعرف               |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |

أخرى:

دانون ☐

المراعي/بينى ☐

لمار ☐

دومنى ☐

س١٠. هل حصل وعابر تشتري دانون ومالفتهوش في المحل؟ \*

أبوه كثير ☐

أبوه كدا مرة ☐

لا أبدًا ☐

أنا ما بدوريش على دانون ☐

س١١. آخر مرة دانون ماكناش متوفر، عملت إيه؟ (لو حصل)

اشتريت ماركه تانية ☐

رجعت محل تاني عشان أألفي دانون ☐

ماشتريش زبادي خالص ☐

استنيت واشتريت بعدين ☐

أخرى:

س١٢. مقارنة بجهينة، إن إني أألفي دانون في المحلات القريبة مني: \*

أسهل بكثير ☐

أسهل شوية ☐

نفس الشيء ☐

أصعب شوية ☐

أصعب بكثير ☐

القسم هـ – الاتجاهات

س١٣. قد إيه بتوافق على العبارات دي؟ \*

| ١ - لا أوافق بشدة     | ٢                     | ٣                     | ٤                     | ٥ - أوافق بشدة        |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
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| <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |
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| <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> | <input type="radio"/> |

بتوافق منتجات جهينة في كل مكان تقريبًا بتشتري منه ☐

دانون أصعب في إني أألفيه من ماركات الزبادي التانية ☐

لو ماركتي المفصلة مش متوفرة، بتشتري أي حاجة متوفرة ☐

توافق المنتج ☐

أخرى:

توافق المنتج ☐

في أقرب محل لثا ياتر بقوة على اختياري للماركة ☐

كنت تشتري دانون أكثر لو كان أسهل في إني أألفيه ☐

القسم و – بيانات عامة

س١٤. السن: \*

أقل من ٢٠ ☐

٢٩-٣٠ ☐

٣٩-٤٠ ☐

٤٩-٥٠ ☐

٥٠+ ☐

س١٥. النوع: \*

ذكر ☐

أنثى ☐

س١٦. المحافظة: \*

إحداثك

س١٧. نوع المنطقة: \*

وسط مدينة كبيرة ☐

مدينة / صاحبة ☐

قرية / ريف ☐

س١٨. متوسط دخل الأسرة الشهري تقريبًا:

أقل من ١٠ آلاف ☐

٢٠-٣٠ آلاف ☐

٤٠-٥٠ آلاف ☐

أكثر من ٤٠ ألف جنيه ☐

أفضل عدم الذكر ☐

إرسال

دم إرسال كلمات المرور غير متاح حاليًا.

لم يتم إنشاء هذا المحتوى ولا استخدامه من قبل Google.

هل يبدو هذا النموذج مرتبًا؟

نماذج Google

Live Google Form, Egyptian Arabic, 22 items in 4 sections. Read left to right, top to bottom.

# Sources Behind Every Number

*Same numbered sources as the written report. Every figure quoted in this deck traces to one of these. Accessed June 2026.*

- 1 Malhotra, N. K. Essentials of Marketing Research, 1st Edition, Pearson. The research process, problem definition, research design, secondary data, qualitative research, and surveys.
- 2 Juhayna Food Industries: Distribution (company website) + published strategic analysis. 39 distribution centers, 1,000+ vehicles, ~243,000 retail outlets. [juhayna.com/farm-to-fork/distribution](https://juhayna.com/farm-to-fork/distribution)
- 3 Danone Egypt: About Us and Impact (company website). 7 direct + 24 indirect distribution centers, ~100,000 points of sale, OMDA rural micro-distribution (~380 micro-distributors, ~50,000 retailers). [danone.eg/about-us-new](https://danone.eg/about-us-new) · [danone.eg/impact](https://danone.eg/impact)
- 4 USDA Foreign Agricultural Service: Egypt Retail Foods Report (GAIN). Traditional grocers ~96.6% of outlets, ~74% of dairy sales, ~113,724 grocers. [apps.fas.usda.gov](https://apps.fas.usda.gov) (GAIN: Retail Foods, Cairo, Egypt)
- 5 Euromonitor International: Yoghurt and Sour Milk Products in Egypt. Category leadership among Lactalis, Almarai/Beyti, Juhayna. [euromonitor.com/yoghurt-and-sour-milk-products-in-egypt/report](https://euromonitor.com/yoghurt-and-sour-milk-products-in-egypt/report)
- 6 Mordor Intelligence: Middle East and Africa Dairy Market. Corroborates market size and growth. [mordorintelligence.com/industry-reports/middle-east-and-africa-dairy-market](https://mordorintelligence.com/industry-reports/middle-east-and-africa-dairy-market)
- 7 Futurism (Vocal Media): Egypt Dairy Products and Eggs Market Analysis. Market ~USD 2,367.9M (2024), projected ~USD 5,237.1M (2033). [vocal.media/futurism/egypt-dairy-products-and-eggs-market-analysis...](https://vocal.media/futurism/egypt-dairy-products-and-eggs-market-analysis...)